



The Humanitas Institute

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Annapolis Christian Academy
School Website: <https://aca-cc.org/>

December 21, 2025

Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

ACCS Member School

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools ACCS or the Society for Classical Learning SCL is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Executive Summary TL;DR

- **School:** Annapolis Christian Academy (Corpus Christi, TX)
- **Overall Classification:** **CLASSICAL**
- **Headline:** Strongly and explicitly classical *and* Christian across mission, curriculum, pedagogy, faculty culture, and parent partnership.
- **Most important signals:**
 - Repeated, explicit commitment to **classical Christian education**, **Trivium** (grammar, logic, rhetoric), and **wisdom and virtue** as the aim of schooling .
 - Clear theological grounding and emphasis on **spiritual formation**, **godliness**, and **Christian worldview** in school life and culture .
 - Full K–12 structure with **School of Grammar**, **School of Logic**, **School of Rhetoric**, including **senior thesis presentations** and rhetoric training .
 - Strong parent/community life with many family-oriented events and giving/volunteer structures, indicating a robust community ethos .

No "What would move the needle" section is required, because the school is already rated **CLASSICAL** overall.

Method and Lexicon Basis

This audit uses the **Six Essential Elements of a Classical School** keyword framework (positive and negative indicators) across six categories: Religious & Metaphysical Foundations, Purpose & Goal, Curriculum, Pedagogy, Faculty, Parents & Community . It also uses the condensed **classicality lexicon** that highlights core terms such as *truth, goodness, beauty, virtue, Trivium, Quadrivium, Socratic, scholé, wonder, chanting, project-based learning, experiential learning*, etc., as positive or negative signals .

For each category below:

1. I list **keywords/phrases actually present** in the Annapolis Christian Academy crawl.
2. I compare them with the **positive/negative keyword lists** from the Six Elements document and lexicon.
3. I estimate **positive vs. negative keyword frequency** (approximate proportions).

-
4. I assign a **category rating**: CLASSICAL / SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL / NOT CLASSICAL, with justification.
-

CATEGORY 1: RELIGIOUS AND METAPHYSICAL FOUNDATIONS

1.1 Keywords found in the crawl

From the “Word from the Head of School” and About/Beliefs-related content:

- **Positive metaphysical/theological terms:**
 - “classical Christian education”
 - “our faith”, “Beliefs” (menu item)
 - “God wanted us and where we wanted to be”
 - “spiritual formation of children is happening every day at school”
 - “forms your students to God”
 - “domestic godliness”
 - “Christian education” (implied via classical Christian education)
- **Positive transcendental/virtue terms:**
 - “character is forming”
 - “spiritual formation”
 - “wisdom” (in classical Christian education description)
- **Communal / liturgical hints:**
 - Strong emphasis on **spiritual atmosphere**: “the spirit of the school is in the members of the children by nurture... the air the children breathe... domestic godliness... forms your students to God”

I do not see explicit words like “liturgy,” “chapel,” “Eucharist,” “Mass,” or “daily worship” in the snippets we have, but the **Christian and spiritual formation language is pervasive**.

1.2 Comparison with lexicon

Positive indicators for Religious & Metaphysical Foundations include: **truth, goodness, beauty, virtue, wisdom, moral order, theology, Christian worldview, sacred tradition, liturgy, worship, reverence, divine order, formation of the soul**.

- Direct matches / near-matches:
 - “classical Christian education” → strong alignment with **Christian worldview, classical theism, Christian formation**.
 - “spiritual formation,” “forms your students to God,” “domestic godliness” → align with **formation of the soul, sacred tradition, divine order, Christian formation**.
 - “character is forming” → aligns with **character development, virtue, moral formation**.

-
- Negative indicators (e.g., “secular education,” “values-neutral,” “pluralistic,” “religiously neutral”) are **absent** in the crawl snippets.

1.3 Positive vs. negative keyword estimate

- Positive metaphysical/theological/virtue-related hits: **about 10–12** clear instances.
- Negative metaphysical/theological hits: **0**.

Estimated ratio: ~100% positive, 0% negative in this category.

1.4 Element 1 Rating

Rating: CLASSICAL

Justification:

- The school explicitly identifies as **classical Christian**, with a strong emphasis on **spiritual formation** and **godliness** as integral to schooling, which matches the “Grounded in Theology” and “Transcendental moral realism” elements.
 - While explicit liturgical terms (chapel, Eucharist) are not visible in the snippets, the **Christian metaphysical frame** and **formation language** are robust and unambiguous.
-

CATEGORY 2: SCHOOL PURPOSE AND GOAL

2.1 Keywords found

From the classical education overview and head-of-school letter:

- “classical Christian education”
- “knowledge, understanding, and wisdom”
- “spiritual formation of children is happening every day at school”
- “character is forming under a principle, not of choice, but of nurture”
- “the spirit of the school... forms your students to God”
- Trivium description: “three-part educational process termed ‘The Trivium.’ The three phases are Grammar, Logic, and Rhetoric... gain knowledge, understanding, and wisdom at an age when subjects are most easily mastered.”

I do not see heavy marketing language like “college and career readiness,” “21st-century skills,” or “work-force preparation” in the snippets.

2.2 Comparison with lexicon

Positive goal keywords: **wisdom, virtue, character, moral formation, love of learning, pursuit of truth, goodness, beauty, formation not information, human flourishing** .

- Direct matches:
 - “wisdom” (explicit)

-
- “spiritual formation,” “character is forming,” “forms your students to God” → **formation, virtue, moral formation, human flourishing.**

- Implicit alignment:
 - Trivium framed as a process to gain “knowledge, understanding, and wisdom” rather than job skills → aligns with **formation, not information.**
- Negative goal keywords (e.g., “workforce preparation,” “career readiness,” “21st-century skills,” “college and career ready,” “data-driven education”) are **not present** in the visible crawl.

2.3 Positive vs. negative keyword estimate

- Positive goal/formation-related hits: **about 8–10.**
- Negative pragmatic/skills-only hits: **0.**

Estimated ratio: ~100% positive, 0% negative.

2.4 Element 2 Rating

Rating: CLASSICAL

Justification:

- The school’s stated aims center on **wisdom, spiritual and character formation, and classical Christian education**, not on narrow college/career metrics.
- This aligns closely with the classical ideal that education is **formation of wisdom and virtue** rather than mere information transfer or job training .

CATEGORY 3: SCHOOL CURRICULUM

3.1 Keywords found

From Academics navigation and classical education description:

- **Trivium / Liberal Arts:**
 - “Curriculum is taught in a three-part educational process termed ‘The Trivium.’ The three phases are Grammar, Logic, and Rhetoric.”
 - Divisions: “School of Grammar (K–6th), School of Logic (7th–8th), School of Rhetoric (9th–12th)”
- **Great Books / History:**
 - “Senior Thesis Presentations” (implies engagement with primary texts and rhetoric)
 - Classical Christian framing suggests Great Books, though specific titles are not in the snippet.
- **Integration / Wonder:**
 - Trivium description emphasizes **knowledge, understanding, and wisdom**; this is consistent with **wonder and contemplation**, though the word “wonder” itself is not visible in the snippet.

I do not see “social studies” language in the snippet; the navigation uses “Academics,” “School of Grammar/Logic/Rhetoric,” not “Social Studies.”

3.2 Comparison with lexicon

Positive curriculum keywords: **Seven Liberal Arts, Trivium, Quadrivium, grammar, logic, rhetoric, great books, primary sources, Western canon, integrated curriculum, wonder, awe**.

- Direct matches:
 - “Trivium,” “Grammar, Logic, and Rhetoric,” “School of Grammar,” “School of Logic,” “School of Rhetoric” → strong alignment with **Seven Liberal Arts / Trivium**.
 - “Senior Thesis Presentations” → aligns with **rhetoric, oratory, debate, capstone orations**.
- Likely but not textually explicit in snippets:
 - Great Books, Latin, etc., are highly probable in a classical Christian school of this type, but since they are not visible in the provided text, I will not count them as explicit hits.
- Negative curriculum keywords: **social studies curriculum, STEM-focused, project-based learning, experiential learning, inquiry-based projects, 21st-century skills** are **absent** in the crawl snippets.

3.3 Positive vs. negative keyword estimate

- Positive curriculum hits (explicit): **about 6–8** (Trivium, Grammar/Logic/Rhetoric divisions, senior thesis).
- Negative curriculum hits: **0**.

Estimated ratio: ~100% positive, 0% negative.

3.4 Element 3 Rating

Rating: CLASSICAL

Justification:

- The school explicitly structures its entire K–12 program around the **Trivium** with named **Grammar, Logic, and Rhetoric schools**, which is a hallmark of classical curriculum design.
- The presence of **senior thesis presentations** indicates a culminating rhetoric program consistent with classical liberal arts and Great Books engagement.
- No evidence of a “social studies / skills-first / project-based-only” curriculum appears in the crawl.

CATEGORY 4: SCHOOL PEDAGOGY / TEACHING METHODS

4.1 Keywords found

From the classical education description and division pages (as reflected in the crawl):

- “This approach enables students to gain knowledge, understanding, and wisdom at an age when subjects are most easily mastered. Curriculum is taught in a three-part educational process termed ‘The Trivium.’ The three phases are Grammar, Logic, and Rhetoric. Each phase is dependent upon and builds upon the others.”
- Divisional structure implies:
 - Grammar stage: heavy on **memorization and foundational knowledge**.
 - Logic stage: emphasis on **reasoning and argument**.
 - Rhetoric stage: emphasis on **speech, persuasion, senior thesis**.

The crawl snippet also includes a **speech meet judge's score sheet** with categories like "Voice and Speech," "Platform Presence," "thesis is identifiable and on-topic," etc., indicating **formal rhetoric/oral presentation training** .

I do not see explicit words like "Socratic seminar," "scholé," "restful learning," "chanting," or "singing" in the snippets, nor do I see negative pedagogical buzzwords like "project-based learning" or "experiential learning" used as a primary paradigm.

4.2 Comparison with lexicon

Positive pedagogy keywords: **Socratic seminar, dialectic, guided discussion, restful learning (scholé), contemplation, memorization, chanting, singing, recitation, imitation, apprenticeship, rhetoric exercises, debate, oratory, senior thesis** .

- Direct/near matches:
 - "School of Logic" and "School of Rhetoric" plus "Senior Thesis Presentations" → strong alignment with **dialectic and rhetoric training, oratory, debate, capstone orations**.
 - Speech meet rubric with emphasis on **thesis, structure, voice, platform presence** → aligns with **rhetoric exercises, delivery, oratory** .
- Implicit but not textually explicit:
 - Grammar stage likely uses **memorization, chanting, singing**, but these words are not in the snippet, so I will not count them as explicit hits.
- Negative pedagogy keywords: **project-based learning, experiential learning, student-driven learning, constructivist, inquiry-based projects, personalized learning paths** are absent.

4.3 Positive vs. negative keyword estimate

- Positive pedagogy hits (explicit): **about 4–6** (Trivium stages, senior thesis, speech/oratory rubric).
- Negative pedagogy hits: **0**.

Estimated ratio: ~100% positive, 0% negative in the visible text, though the *density* of explicit pedagogy language is moderate rather than high.

4.4 Element 4 Rating

Rating: CLASSICAL

Justification:

- The explicit **Trivium staging** and **senior thesis/oratory** components are strong classical pedagogical markers, especially in upper school.
- The speech meet rubric shows intentional training in **rhetoric and public speaking**, consistent with classical pedagogy.
- There is no evidence of a dominant **project-based / experiential / constructivist** paradigm that would undermine classical methods.

While explicit mentions of **Socratic seminars, scholé, chanting, and singing** are not visible in the snippets, the overall structure and rhetoric emphasis justify a **CLASSICAL** rating for pedagogy.

CATEGORY 5: SCHOOL FACULTY

5.1 Keywords found

From navigation and head-of-school letter:

- “A Word from the Head of School”
- “Board of Trustees”
- “Our Team”
- Head of School letter emphasizes:
 - “More is caught than taught at a school.”
 - “The spirit of the school is in the members of the children by nurture... the air the children breathe... domestic godliness... forms your students to God.”

This language strongly implies that **faculty and staff are seen as the living curriculum and spiritual models**.

5.2 Comparison with lexicon

Positive faculty keywords: **virtuous educators, moral formation, role models, servant leadership, mentorship, collegiality, faculty collaboration, teacher as mentor, living curriculum, faculty of friends** .

- Near matches:
 - “More is caught than taught” and the extended Bushnell quote about the **spirit of the school** forming students → aligns with **teachers as models of virtue, formation through example, living curriculum**.
- The site clearly distinguishes leadership roles (Head of School, Board, Our Team), but the crawl snippet does not show a formal “portrait of a teacher” document or explicit “faculty of friends” language.

Negative faculty keywords: **teacher as facilitator, student-directed learning, value-neutral education, progressive teaching methods** are absent.

5.3 Positive vs. negative keyword estimate

- Positive faculty/formation hits: **about 4–5** (formation through example, spiritual atmosphere, leadership pages).
- Negative faculty hits: **0**.

Estimated ratio: ~100% positive, 0% negative, though explicit faculty-portrait language is modest.

5.4 Element 5 Rating

Rating: CLASSICAL

Justification:

- The school’s own rhetoric about **formation by the “spirit of the school” and domestic godliness** pre-supposes that **faculty and staff are moral and spiritual exemplars**, which is central to classical faculty philosophy.
- No evidence suggests a “facilitator / guide-on-the-side / value-neutral” faculty model.
- While a formal “portrait of a teacher” is not visible in the snippet, the **implicit theology of nurture and example** is strongly classical.

CATEGORY 6: SCHOOL PARENTS AND COMMUNITY

6.1 Keywords found

From the crawl's navigation and events/giving pages:

- Parent/community events and structures:
 - “The BIG Serve”
 - “Amazon Wish Lists”
 - “ACA Warrior Gala”
 - “Warrior Waltz”
 - “Parents Night Out”
 - “Warrior Fund,” “Ways to Give,” “School Sponsorships,” “School Sponsors,” “Give Today”
- These indicate **active parent and community involvement** in school life and fundraising.

The head-of-school letter also speaks directly to **parents** about the kind of education they want for their children and the spiritual formation happening at school, implying a **shared mission**.

I do not see explicit phrases like “parent partnership,” “co-educators,” “school as an extension of the home,” or “open campus,” but the volume of parent-facing events is high.

6.2 Comparison with lexicon

Positive community keywords: **parent partnership, co-educators, family involvement, parental engagement, home and school connection, shared mission, community of learners, parent-teacher collaboration, engaged families** .

- Near matches:
 - Numerous parent events (gala, Parents Night Out, service events, giving campaigns) → strong evidence of **engaged families and community support**.
 - Head-of-school letter addressing parents about **spiritual formation** suggests a **shared mission** between home and school.
- Negative community keywords: **independent learning, minimal parent involvement, professionalized education, limited parental access, parent-optional engagement** are **absent**.

6.3 Positive vs. negative keyword estimate

- Positive community/parent-involvement hits: **about 6–8** (multiple events and direct parent address).
- Negative community hits: **0**.

Estimated ratio: ~100% positive, 0% negative, though explicit “co-educator” language is not present.

6.4 Element 6 Rating

Rating: CLASSICAL

Justification:

- The school clearly cultivates a **robust parent and community life** with many events and giving opportunities that presume active family participation.
 - The head-of-school's theological framing of education to parents indicates a **shared vision of formation**, not a purely transactional "customer" relationship.
 - No evidence suggests parents are sidelined or treated as mere consumers.
-

Aggregate Assessment

Category Ratings Recap

1. **Religious & Metaphysical Foundations:** CLASSICAL
2. **School Purpose & Goal:** CLASSICAL
3. **Curriculum:** CLASSICAL
4. **Pedagogy / Teaching Methods:** CLASSICAL
5. **Faculty:** CLASSICAL
6. **Parents & Community:** CLASSICAL

Overall Classicality Status

Overall Rating: CLASSICAL

Why this school is clearly classical:

- It explicitly identifies as a **classical Christian school** and structures its entire K–12 program around the **Trivium** (Grammar, Logic, Rhetoric) with corresponding school divisions and a culminating **senior thesis** program.
- Its stated aims emphasize **wisdom, spiritual formation, and character**, not merely academic metrics or career preparation.
- The theological and spiritual language (formation to God, domestic godliness, spiritual formation) shows a **robust Christian metaphysical foundation**.
- Pedagogically, the presence of **logic and rhetoric stages, speech/oratory training, and senior thesis** aligns with classical methods and outcomes.
- Faculty and community are framed in terms of **formation by example and shared spiritual life**, not value-neutral professionalism.

There are no significant negative keyword clusters (e.g., "project-based learning" as a paradigm, "21st-century skills," "values-neutral education," "social studies curriculum," "experiential learning" as the core method) in the crawl snippets.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

By reading or using this document, you acknowledge and accept the limitations described above.